

Order Passeriformes continued

Family Fringillidae

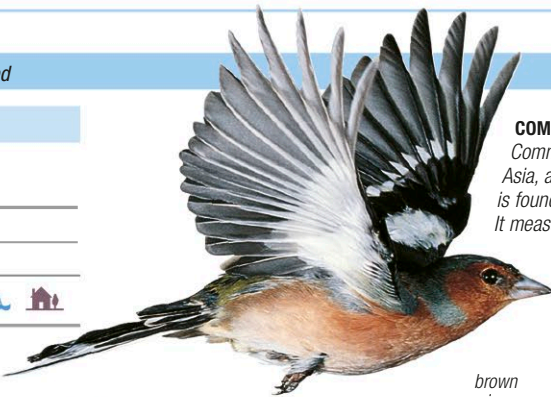
Finches

Length 4¼–7½ in (11–19 cm)

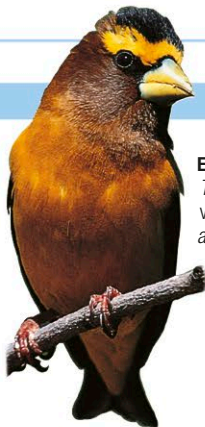
Species 226



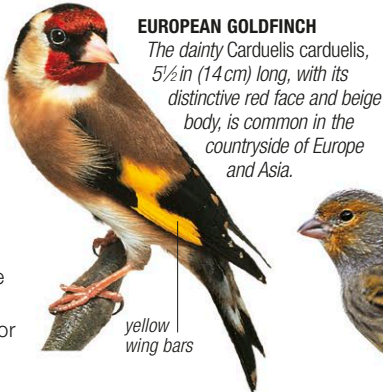
Found in the Americas, Africa, Europe, and Asia, finches have bills that have evolved for feeding on seeds; some species have particularly strong skulls and large jaw muscles to crack very hard seeds. When feeding, they wedge the seeds in a special groove at the side of their palate, then crush them by raising the lower jaw. The husk is peeled off by the tongue and the kernel swallowed. One group—the Hawaiian honeycreepers—have evolved a diversity of bill shapes for different diets: long and slender for taking nectar, or woodpecker-like for probing bark.



COMMON CHAFFINCH
Common in Europe, North Africa, West Asia, and Pakistan, *Fringilla coelebs* is found in open country and woodland. It measures 6 in (15 cm) in length.



EVENING GROSBEEK
This bulky bird, *Hesperiphona vespertina*, is 8 in (20 cm) long, and inhabits coniferous forest across northern North America, moving southward in winter. It is noisy and gregarious.



EUROPEAN GOLDFINCH
The dainty *Carduelis carduelis*, 5½ in (14 cm) long, with its distinctive red face and beige body, is common in the countryside of Europe and Asia.



RED CROSSBILL
A resident of North America, Europe, and Asia, *Loxia curvirostra* is remarkable for its bill. The upper and lower mandibles cross over each other, a feature that allows the bird to extract seeds from ripe pinecones. This bird (female shown) is 6½ in (17 cm) long.



EURASIAN BULLFINCH
The attractive bullfinch, *Pyrrhula pyrrhula*, 6¼ in (16 cm) long, can quickly strip a pear tree of its buds, making it an unpopular bird with fruit-growers. The male's pink breast combined with its gray back and black and white wings make it easy to identify. This bird is found across Europe, and east into China.



ATLANTIC CANARY
The wild ancestor of the common cage bird, *Serinus canaria* is 5 in (13 cm) long and has grayish yellow plumage. It is endemic to the Canary Islands, the Azores, and Madeira, off the west coast of Africa.



AKIAPOLA AU
Hemignathus munroi is a critically endangered species restricted to the koa forest above 3,300 ft (1,000 m) on the slopes of volcanoes of the Big Island of Hawaii. About 5 in (12.5 cm) long, the male is olive-green above, and yellow below, with a yellow head. The female is smaller and duller.



IIWI
A common and noisy species found in native forests above 2,300 ft (700 m) on Hawaii's Big Island, Kauai, and Maui, *Drepanis coccinea* is rare on other Hawaiian islands. The adult, about 5 in (13 cm) long, is bright vermillion, with a long, pink, downcurved bill and a yellow ring around the eye.

Family Thraupidae

Tanagers and relatives

Length 4–11 in (10–28 cm)

Species 375



Confined to the Western Hemisphere, mostly to the tropics, this family contains some of the most colorful American birds. Relatively few tanagers live in the densest parts of tropical forests; they mostly wander in mixed flocks among the

canopy, particularly outside the breeding season. Most birds in this family build open, cup-shaped nests, rarely on the ground. Some feed among low bushes, but few are ground-dwelling birds. They feed on fruit and insects. The euphonias, included within this family, feed on mistletoe berries, while the honeycreepers have bills and

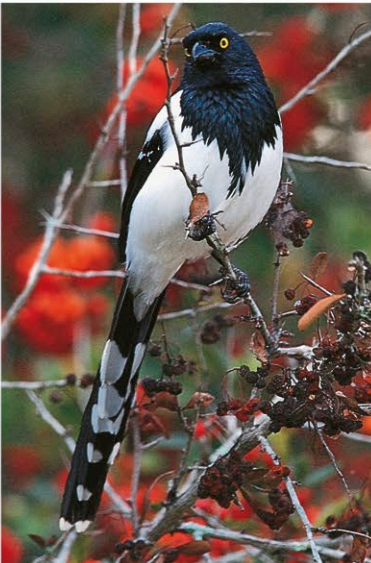
tongues designed for sucking nectar from flowers. A few species follow columns of army ants, catching insects and spiders flushed by the ants. Many remain mated throughout the year and therefore hardly sing at all, but a few species, such as the scarlet tanager, do have attractive songs.



SWALLOW Tanager
A widespread bird in central and northern South America, *Tersina viridis* has long, pointed wings and gets its name because it snatches insects in flight—using a short flattened bill that is slightly hooked at the tip. The female (shown here) is green; the male brilliant turquoise blue. Because of its unusual features, it used to be classified in a separate family, outside the tanagers.



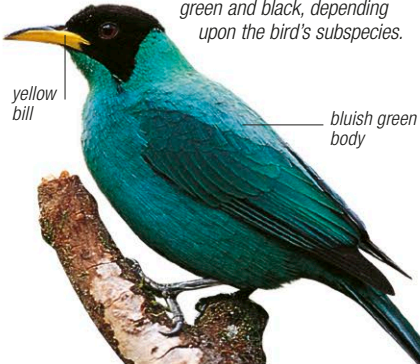
BLUE-NECKED TANAGER
Resident in Bolivia, Brazil, Colombia, Ecuador, Peru, and Venezuela, *Tangara cyanicollis* is found between 1,000 and 7,900 ft (300–2,400 m) in open areas with isolated trees. Both sexes are alike, with a blue hood and throat, and measure 4¼ in (12 cm) in length. The wings are blue and black, or green and black, depending upon the bird's subspecies.



MAGPIE TANAGER
Widespread across South America, *Cissopis leverianus* inhabits scrub in cloud and rain forests and in cultivated and suburban areas. It is 11 in (28 cm) long, with a blue-black head, mantle, throat, and breast. Its long, black tail is edged with white, the wings are black and white, while the belly is white.



COMMON CACTUS FINCH
Found on most of the Galapagos Islands, *Geospiza scandens* is 5½ in (14 cm) long. It specializes in feeding on seeds of *Opuntia* cacti, and has a longer bill and a more pronounced split tongue than other finches, adapted to this purpose.



GREEN HONEYCREEPER
Widespread and common in most countries of northern South America, *Chlorophanes spiza* is also found in Trinidad and Tobago. About 5½ in (14 cm) long, it inhabits forest canopies below 4,900 ft (1,500 m). The male is bright bluish green all over, with a black mask. Both sexes have a yellow bill and red eyes.